

INSTITUTO NEBRIJA | Formación Profesional

Habilidades Comunicativas

Unit 1: Take the Big Leap

This course is divided into four instructional units that develop the linguistic and professional competencies necessary for students to operate successfully in international environments.

Course Evaluation

🎯 First Milestone

Foreigners in Spain

25 %

🔄 Second Milestone

Erasmus

25 %

📝 Final Assessment

Final Content Tasks + Reading + Listening + Writing

25 %

📚 Activities

Course and Final Trimester

25 %

⚠️ To pass the module, it is **mandatory to score at least 5 out of 10 points in both milestones and the final assessment**, as the Learning Outcomes (LOs) are evaluated in all of them. If they are not passed, they will have to be retaken in the extraordinary examination session. The second milestone, being group-based, will be adapted so that it can be completed and evaluated individually in that extraordinary examination session. By law, students are allowed a maximum of 4 attempts before they must take the exam as an independent candidate.

⚠️ You need a **7 or higher in English subjects** to study in York, access Erasmus or work in the U.S.

Attendance and Continuous Assessment Rules

Loss of 15% in a term

If the student exceeds 15% absences in a term, they must sit the checkpoints or tasks completed during that period in the extraordinary examination session, even if they had previously passed some of them.

Loss of 20% in the full course

If the absence rate exceeds 20% over the entire course, the student must sit all tasks in the extraordinary examination session, even if they had already passed some of them.

If the student do not pass in the extraordinary examination session

The student would have to re-enrol in a later course in order to be assessed again.

Contents of Unit 1

Five areas applied to formal and professional contexts:



Vocabulary

Bureaucracy, banking, identity.



Reading

Procedures abroad.



Writing

Formal email.



Listening

First week abroad.



Speaking

Role-play (offices).



GAME

Two Truths and a Lie 🎲

Write two true facts and one lie — your classmates guess which is the lie!

Truth ✅

A real fact about you

Truth ✅

Another real fact

Lie ❌

Sounds true, but isn't!

INTRODUCTION

Introduction to the Unit

During this unit, you will learn how to survive bureaucracy in English.

> 💬 **You have just landed in London. You want to live and work there. What do you need first?**

In pairs, you are going to work on a list. You have to choose five things that you would do first. Then, we will work together on a debate.



VOCABULARY — KEY WORDS

Vocabulary List

- **Passport** → *"At the airport, I realised my passport was the most important document I had."*
- **National Insurance Number** → *"I couldn't start working until I received my National Insurance Number."*
- **Bank account** → *"Opening a bank account was the first thing I did after arriving in the country."*
- **Flat** → *"I was looking for a flat near the city center."*
- **Tax number** → *"My employer asked me for my tax number before paying my first salary."*
- **SIM card** → *"I bought a SIM card so I could use mobile data immediately."*
- **Job interview** → *"I had a job interview next week for a marketing position."*
- **Proof of address** → *"They asked for proof of address, but I was still staying in a temporary room."* ES COMO EL EMPADRONAMIENTO PRUEBA DE ALOJAMIENTO
- **Visa** → *"Without a visa, you cannot stay or work legally in most countries."*
- **Coffee** → *"Let's grab a coffee to discuss the paperwork."*

VOCABULARY — FORMS & DOCUMENTS

Vocabulary: Forms and Documents

- **Application form** → "I spent 20 minutes filling in the application form at the bank." **FORMULARIO DE SOLICITUD**
- **ID (Identification)** → "You must show your ID before entering the building."
- **Passport** → "My passport was checked three times during the application process."
- **Driving licence** → "I used my driving licence as extra identification."
- **Proof of address** → "They rejected my application because I didn't have proof of address."
- **Utility bill** → "A utility bill is one of the easiest ways to prove where you live." **SON LAS FACTURAS DEL APARTAMENTO QUE PRUEBAN QUE VIVES EN UN LUGAR**
- **Bank statement** → "I printed my bank statement to show my financial activity." **ES COMO UN EXTRACTO BANCARIO PARA PROBAR QUE TENEMOS UNA**
- **Signature** → "Don't forget to add your signature at the bottom of the page."

Vocabulary: Money / Banking

- **Savings account** → "I opened a savings account to put money aside every month."
- **Current account** → "My current account is where my salary is paid every month."
- **Bank account** → "You need a bank account to receive payments from your employer."
- **Fees / Charges** → "Some banks charge monthly fees for maintaining your account." **COMISIONES / CARGOS**
- **Cash withdrawal** → "I made a cash withdrawal because the café didn't accept cards." **SACAR DINERO DEL CAJERO**

Vocabulary: Work / Tax

- **Tax number** → "Your tax number links your income to the government system."
- **National Insurance Number** → "In the UK, your National Insurance Number is essential for employment."
- **Employer** → "My employer helped me complete all the paperwork."
- **Employee** → "As an employee, you are responsible for reporting your hours."
- **Payslip** → "I checked my payslip to see my salary and deductions." **NOMINA TAMBIEN SE DICE PAYROLL**

Vocabulary: Useful Verbs

- **Apply for** → "I decided to apply for a new job in marketing." **SOLICITAR ALGO**
- **Fill in** → "You need to fill in this form before your appointment." **RELLENAR**
- **Provide** → "They asked me to provide proof of address." **PROPORCIONAR**
- **Sign** → "Please sign the document before submitting it." **FIRMA**
- **Submit** → "You must submit your application before the deadline." **ENVIAR / SUBIR**

Vocabulary: Useful Phrases

- "Could you repeat that, please?"
- "What documents do I need?"
- "Where do I sign?"
- "How long does the process take?"
- "Is there a fee?"
- "Can I apply online?"

DE UN ADJETIVO PODEMOS TRANSFORMARLO EN ADVERBIO CON EL -LY

VOCABULARY — PRAC

Word Transformation: rewrite the sentence using the word given. Keep the same meaning.

1. You cannot start working if you do not have a tax number. → A tax number is **essential for start working** (ESSENTIAL)
2. I filled in the form, but I made several mistakes. → I completed the application form **but it's not accurate** // **but I don't do it accurate** **INACCURATELY (adverbio)** (ACCURATELY)
3. They refused my request because I didn't provide proof of address. → My application was **rejected because it have a lack of my proof of address NO SE PUEDE UTILIZAR HAVE** (LACK) **SE PUEDE UTILIZAR DUE TO (debido a) --> refected due to the lack of proof of address**
4. I had to sign the document before leaving the bank. → The document required **my signature** (SIGNATURE)
5. I opened a savings account so I could save regularly. → The purpose of the account was **to allow me have some savings** (ALLOW)

VOCABULARY — PRACTICE

Error Correction: Each sentence has ONE mistake. Find and correct it.

1. I will apply to a bank account tomorrow. **APPLY FOR A BANK ACCOUNT because it go with for not with to**
2. She provided me a proof of address. **proof of address don't have the A determinant because proof of addres it's an uncountable noun**
3. He signed on the document without reading it. **SIGNED THE DOCUMENT because we don't sign ON**
4. My employer gave me a advice about taxes. **GIVE ME ADVICE because advice it's an uncountable noun**
5. I did a cash withdrawal of 500 euros from my saving account. **ITS SAVINGS IT MUST HAVE THE S AT THE FINAL OF THE WORD**
6. You must fill up the application form carefully. **FILL IN THE APPLICATION, because it's a phrasal verb**



In my opinion the most complicated administrative proccess it can be apply for a national insurance number because it may have a lot of documents to present and the burocracy it must be a hell.
If you don't have a proof of address you cannot access to a job or to a Visa.
The tax number it's essential because without it you cannot

SPEAKING — PRACTICE

Speaking Task

Answer in 4–5 sentences using at least 3 vocabulary items.

1. Describe the most complicated administrative process you imagine when moving abroad.
2. Explain the difference between a savings account and a current account in your own words.
3. What problems can happen if you don't have a proof of address?
4. Why is a tax number essential in most countries?
5. Describe a realistic job interview process abroad.

LISTENING — COMPREHENSION

Listening: "The First Week Abroad" 🎧

Watch the video https://youtu.be/2G-m60L_Ck0?is=wPZ2yQrC-Je2r_qT and answer the following questions:

1. What is the main purpose of the procedure shown in the video?
2. Which authorities are responsible for checking travellers when they enter the United States?
3. What is the difference between immigration control and customs control?
4. What information may travellers be required to provide when entering the country?
5. Why is it important for travellers to have their documents ready?
6. What can happen if a traveller provides incomplete or incorrect information?

LISTENING — COMPREHENSION

Listening: "The First Week Abroad" 🎧

Watch the video again. Find or identify the words/expressions related to these definitions.

1. The official process of checking whether someone can enter a country.
2. The official document used to identify a traveller internationally.
3. The place where a traveller is going to stay.
4. The reason why someone is travelling.
5. The process of checking goods brought into a country.
6. A person who travels from one country to another.
7. The legal permission to enter or remain in a country.
8. Goods or objects carried by a traveller.

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READING – ACTIVITY

"The Mystery Form" (I)

HM RESIDENT SERVICES

NEW ARRIVAL REGISTRATION FORM (UK)

Please complete all sections in black ink and use CAPITAL LETTERS.

SECTION A – PERSONAL DETAILS

Title:

☐ Mr ☐ Mrs ☐ Miss ☐ Ms ☐ Other

Surname / Family Name: _____

First Name(s): _____

Date of Birth (DD/MM/YYYY): _____

Country of Birth: _____

Nationality: _____

Passport Number: _____

National Identity Card Number (if applicable):

SECTION B – UK ADDRESS

House Number / Street Name:

Town / City: _____

Postcode: _____

Date moved to this address: _____

Proof of address attached:

☐ Tenancy agreement

☐ Utility bill

☐ Bank letter

☐ Other

SECTION C – CONTACT INFORMATION

Mobile Number: _____

Email Address: _____

READING – ACTIVITY

"The Mystery Form" (II)

SECTION D – EMPLOYMENT STATUS

Please tick one box:

☐ Employed
☐ Self-employed
☐ Student
☐ Unemployed
☐ Looking for work

Current Occupation: _____

Employer Name (if applicable): _____

SECTION E – NATIONAL INSURANCE

Do you already have a National Insurance Number?

☐ Yes
☐ No

If yes, please write it below:

SECTION F – BANKING DETAILS

Do you currently hold a UK bank account?

☐ Yes
☐ No

Preferred account type:

☐ Current Account
☐ Savings Account

SECTION G – DECLARATION

I declare that the information given on this form is true and complete to the best of my knowledge.

Signature: _____

Date: _____

READING — ACTIVITY

"The Mystery Form" (III)

Once you have read the document, you have 10 minutes to investigate the form and answer the questions:

- What type of form is it?
- Who uses it?
- What words do they understand?
- Which words sound complicated but are actually easy?
- Would this form be easy or difficult to complete in real life? Why?

Useful expressions: I think this is a…, Maybe it is for…, This word probably means…, They are asking for…, I recognise the word…, I'm not sure, but I think…

VOCABULARY — ACTIVITY

Categorise the following words: passport, tax number, bank statement, savings account, signature, utility bill, employer, ID card, application form

📄 Documents	🏦 Banking	💼 Work
(Students fill in)	(Students fill in)	(Students fill in)

- What documents do you need to open a bank account?
- What can be used as proof of address?
- Why do workers need a tax number?
- What is the difference between a savings account and a current account?

SPEAKING — ACTIVITY

Activity: Find Someone Who...

Walk around the class and ask classmates. You should transform these sentences into questions:

Has a passport	Has filled in an online form recently	Has opened a bank account
Knows what a tax number is	Has used a public service website	Has made an appointment online
Prefers doing paperwork online	Thinks official forms are confusing	Has waited in a queue for paperwork
Has completed a registration form	Has applied for a job online	Has travelled to another country
Has used ID this month		

GAME 🎮

Game: Translation Race 🏆

🎤 Teacher Speaks

The teacher says a sentence using vocabulary studied so far.

🏃 3 Students to the Board

Three students race to write the sentence correctly on the whiteboard.

❌ Slowest Is Eliminated

The two fastest writers stay in — the slowest sits down!

🏆 Last Two Win!

The game continues until only the two fastest students remain — and they get a reward! 🎉

WRITING — FORMAL EMAIL

You have recently moved to Dublin to start a training course. You need to apply for a Personal Public Service Number (PPS Number), but you don't know the procedure.

Write a formal email INCLUDING the following points:

- Explain why you are writing
- Ask what documents you need
- Ask if you need an appointment
- Ask how long the process usually takes
- Ask if you can apply online
- Use an appropriate opening and closing





WRITING — FORMAL EMAIL

Writing: Formal Email

Useful Expressions:

- I am writing to enquire about…
- I would like to know….
- Could you please tell me…?
- I would also like to ask whether…
- I would appreciate your help.
- I look forward to hearing from you.

Subject: Request for Information about PPS Number Application

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am writing to enquire about the procedure for applying for a PPS Number, as I have recently moved to Dublin to begin a VET course.

I would like to know which documents are required for the application process. At the moment, I have my passport, a rental agreement and a letter from my training centre. Please let me know if any additional documents are necessary.

I would also like to ask whether it is necessary to book an appointment in advance or if I can attend the office directly.

Furthermore, could you please tell me how long the process usually takes? I would also like to know if it is possible to fill the application online.

Thank you very much for your time and assistance.

Yours faithfully,
María Sosa

WRITING — PRACTICE

You want to open a bank account in the UK, but the bank says your documents are incomplete.

Write an email (120–150 words) to the bank asking:

- What documents you still need
- If a passport is enough ID
- If you can send documents online
- How long the process takes



READING — TEXT

Take the Big Leap: Getting Ready for Life Abroad (I)

Moving to another country can be exciting, but there are several important steps to complete before starting your new life. Many people need to deal with official documents, applications, and administrative procedures.

One of the first things you may need to do is fill in an application form. This document is used to request a service or registration. For example, you might need an application form to obtain a tax number or register for healthcare services.

When completing official procedures, you will usually have to prove your identity. You can do this by showing an ID card, a passport, or a driving licence. In addition, many organisations require proof of address, which shows where you live. Common examples include a utility bill, a bank statement, or a tenancy agreement.

READING — TEXT

Take the Big Leap: Getting Ready for Life Abroad (II)

Another important step is opening a bank account. Most employers prefer to pay salaries directly into a bank account. Banks usually offer two main types of accounts. A current account is used for everyday transactions, while a savings account is designed to help people save money over time.

If you want to work in another country, you will probably need a tax number or a social security number. Employers use this information to register workers and pay taxes correctly.

Although bureaucracy may seem difficult at first, understanding key terms such as application form, ID, proof of address, tax number, and savings account can make the process much easier. Being prepared and organised will help you feel more confident when dealing with official procedures abroad.



READING — COMPREHENSION

Answer the questions.

1. What is an application form used for? It is used o request a service or registration.
2. Name two documents that can be used as ID. Passport and driving license.
3. What is proof of address? It proves where you live.
4. What is the difference between a current account and a savings account? A current account is used for everyday transactions, while a savings account is designed to help people save money over time.
5. Why do employers need a tax number?

   Because employers use this information to register workers and pay taxes correctly.

READING — COMPREHENSION

True or False?

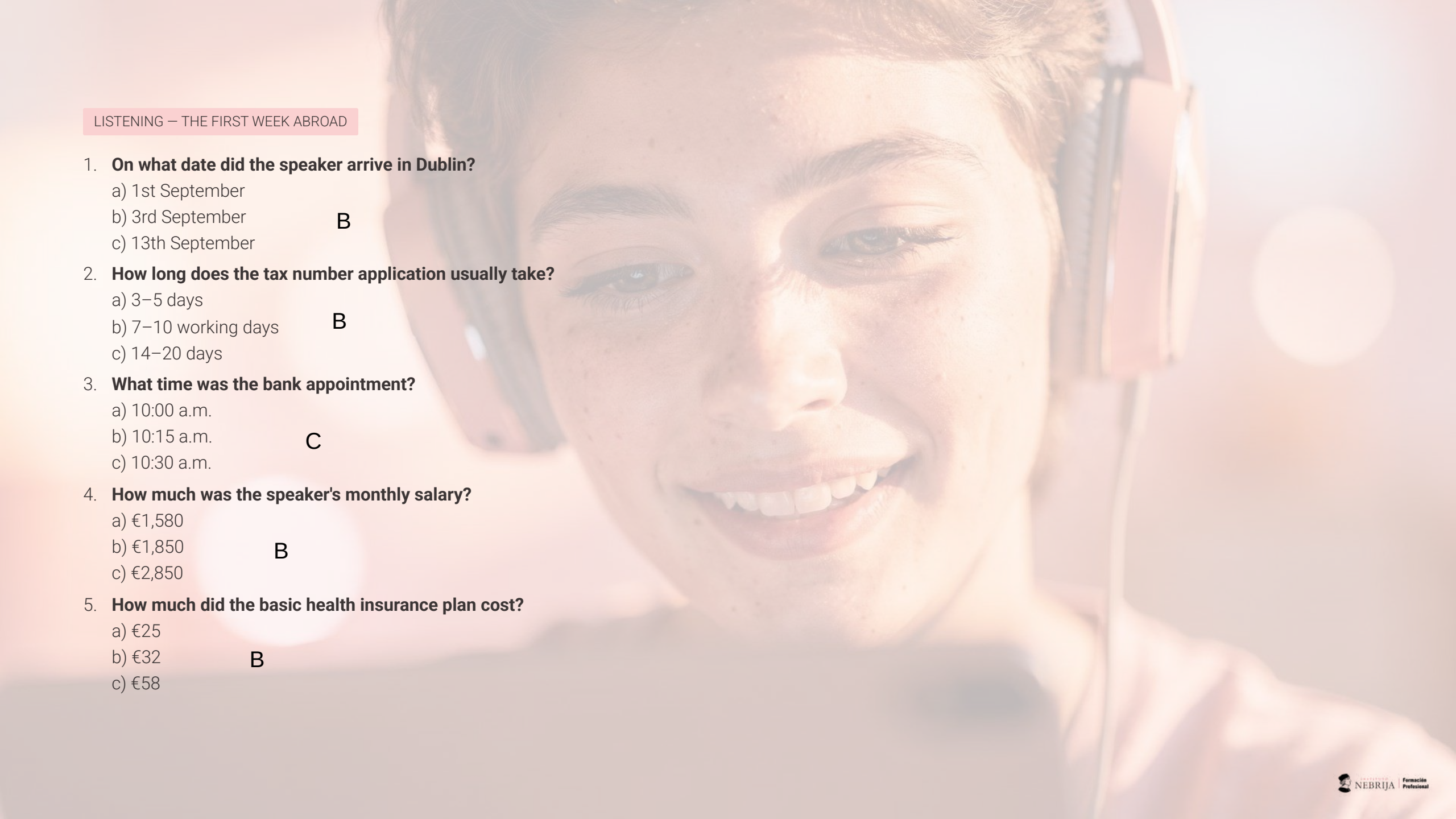
1. A passport can be used to prove your identity. true
2. A savings account is mainly used for daily payments. false
3. A utility bill can be used as proof of address. true
4. You never need documents to open a bank account. false
5. Knowing key vocabulary can help with official procedures. true

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Find the words in the text that mean:

1. A document used to request a service: application form
2. A document that proves who you are: ID card
3. Evidence of where you live: proof of addres
4. A bank account used to save money: savings account
5. An official number used for taxes: tax number





LISTENING — THE FIRST WEEK ABROAD

1. **On what date did the speaker arrive in Dublin?**
   a) 1st September
   b) 3rd September
   c) 13th September

   B

2. **How long does the tax number application usually take?**
   a) 3–5 days
   b) 7–10 working days
   c) 14–20 days

   B

3. **What time was the bank appointment?**
   a) 10:00 a.m.
   b) 10:15 a.m.
   c) 10:30 a.m.

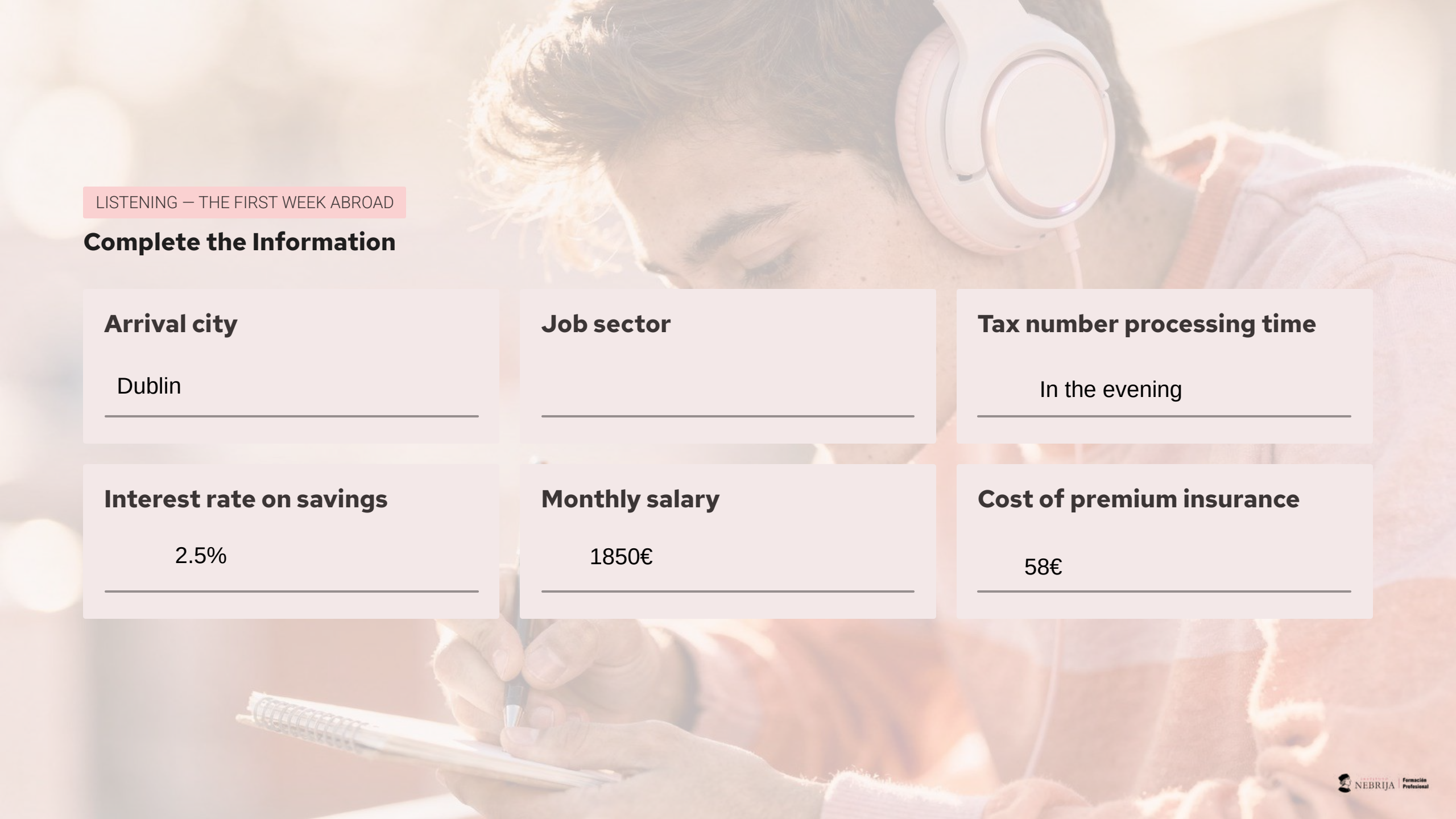
   C

4. **How much was the speaker's monthly salary?**
   a) €1,580
   b) €1,850
   c) €2,850

   B

5. **How much did the basic health insurance plan cost?**
   a) €25
   b) €32
   c) €58

   B



LISTENING — THE FIRST WEEK ABROAD

Complete the Information

Arrival city

Dublin

Job sector

Tax number processing time

In the evening

Interest rate on savings

2.5%

Monthly salary

1850€

Cost of premium insurance

58€

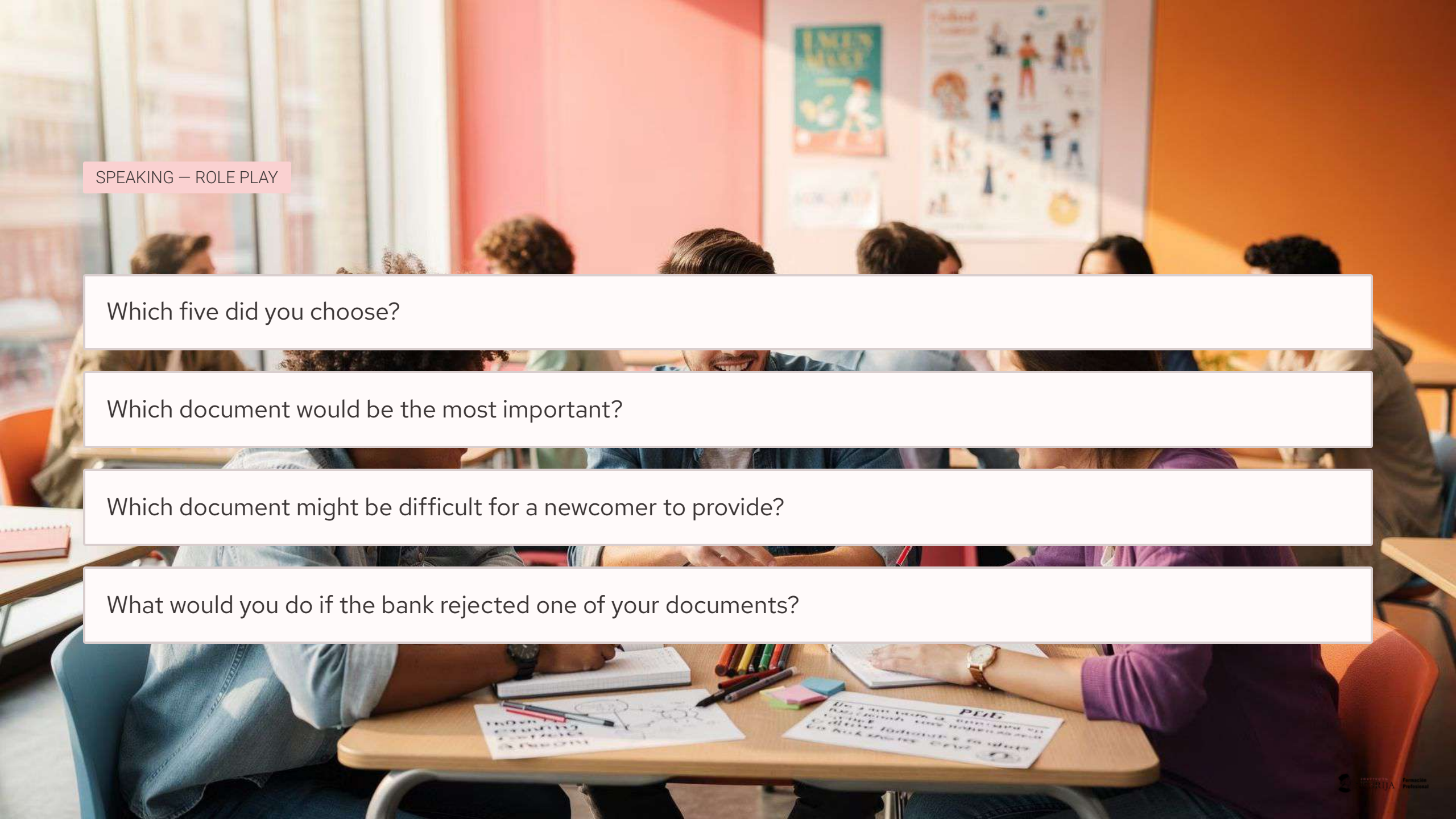
SPEAKING — ROLE PLAY

Going to the Bank

Imagine you have just moved to London or New York. You need a bank account, but you don't know how the system works. We are going to learn how to open an account and deal with a bank in English.

Choose the 5 most useful items. What would you take with you?

- ☐ Passport
- ☐ Driving licence
- ☐ Proof of address
- ☐ Employment contract
- ☐ Payslip
- ☐ Bank statement
- ☐ Tax identification number
- ☐ Rental agreement
- ☐ Utility bill
- ☐ University/college enrolment letter
- ☐ Debit card from your Spanish bank
- ☐ Cash



SPEAKING — ROLE PLAY

Which five did you choose?

Which document would be the most important?

Which document might be difficult for a newcomer to provide?

What would you do if the bank rejected one of your documents?

BANKING VOCABULARY

Banking Vocabulary: Essentials (I)

Term	Meaning
current account 🇬🇧 / checking account 🇺🇸	account for everyday banking
savings account	account designed for saving money
account holder	person who owns the account
branch	physical bank office
bank representative	employee who assists customers
debit card	card that uses money from your account

BANKING VOCABULARY

Banking Vocabulary: Essentials (II)

Term	Meaning
cash withdrawal	taking money out of an account
deposit	money put into an account
bank transfer	moving money from one account to another
direct debit	automatic payment authorised by the customer
standing order	regular fixed payment arranged in advance
overdraft	facility allowing you to spend more than the balance



BANKING VOCABULARY

🇬🇧 VS 🇺🇸

UK: current account | **US:** checking account

UK: sort code | **US:** routing number

UK: cashpoint / cash machine | **US:** ATM

UK: standing order | **US:** recurring payment / automatic payment

BANKING VOCABULARY

Fees and Conditions

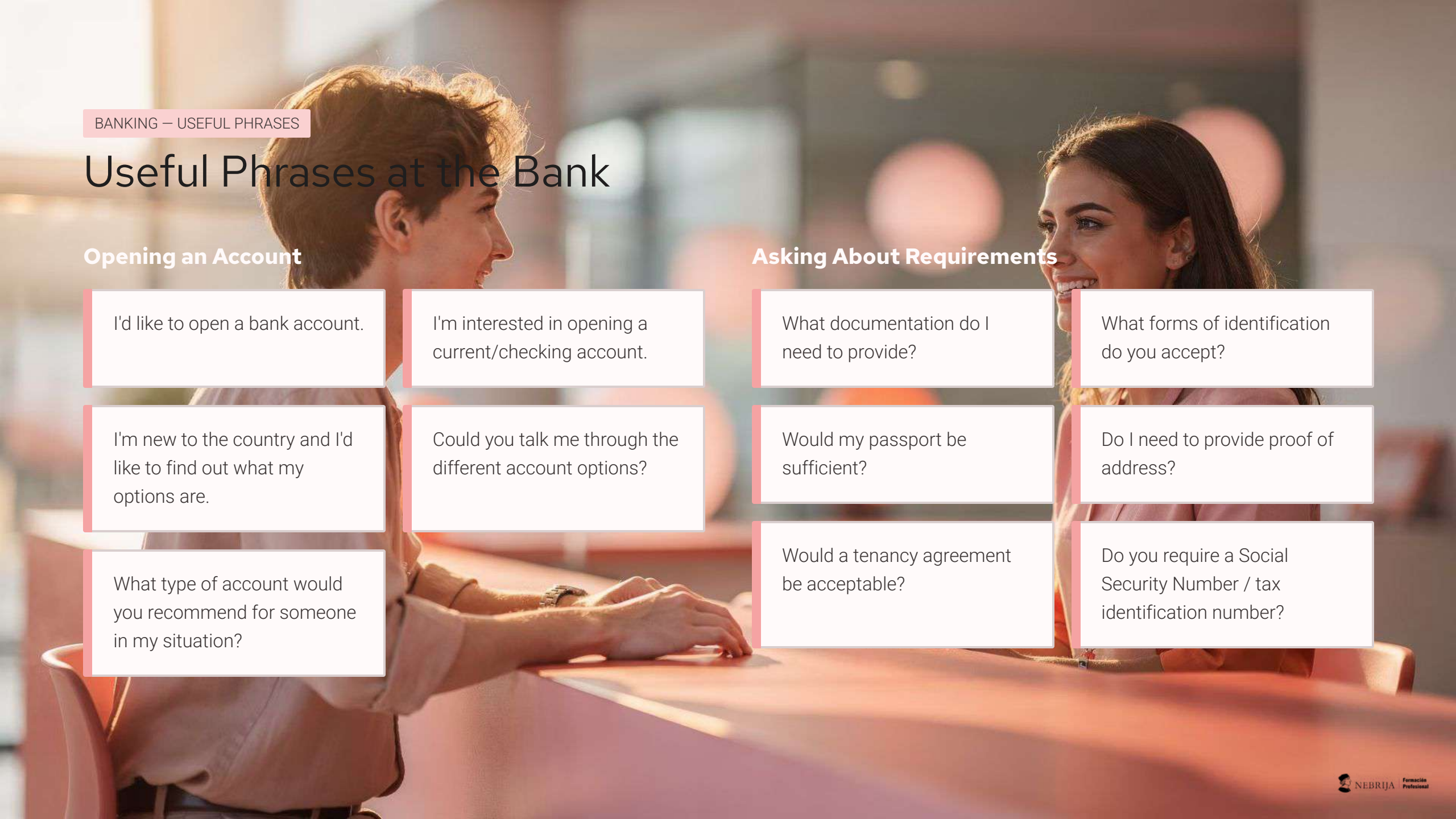
monthly maintenance fee	transaction fee
ATM fee	foreign transaction fee
overdraft fee	minimum balance
interest rate	annual percentage yield (APY)
exchange rate	account terms and conditions
fee waiver	eligibility requirements

Useful Questions

- Is there a monthly maintenance fee?
- Is there a minimum balance requirement?
- Are there any transaction fees?
- Would I be charged for using an ATM abroad?
- Is there an overdraft facility?
- What are the conditions for waiving the monthly fee?

BANKING — USEFUL PHRASES

Useful Phrases at the Bank



Opening an Account

- I'd like to open a bank account.
- I'm interested in opening a current/checking account.
- I'm new to the country and I'd like to find out what my options are.
- Could you talk me through the different account options?
- What type of account would you recommend for someone in my situation?

Asking About Requirements

- What documentation do I need to provide?
- What forms of identification do you accept?
- Would my passport be sufficient?
- Do I need to provide proof of address?
- Would a tenancy agreement be acceptable?
- Do you require a Social Security Number / tax identification number?

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BANKING — VOCABULARY

Collocations!

Match the verbs with the correct banking nouns:

Verbs

- Open
- Close
- Make
- Transfer
- Pay
- Incur
- Maintain
- Exceed
- Provide
- Verify
- Access

Banking Nouns

- your account
- your identity
- your overdraft limit
- supporting documentation
- a minimum balance
- a deposit
- a withdrawal
- funds
- a fee
- a charge
- an account

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BANKING — VOCABULARY

Don't Confuse These!

- Fee vs. Charge
- Deposit vs. Withdrawal
- Debit card vs. Credit card
- Current/Checking account vs. Savings account
- Direct debit vs. Standing order
- Balance vs. Available balance
- Interest rate vs. Exchange rate
- Overdraft vs. Loan

BANKING — VOCABULARY

Vocabulary in Context

Fill in the blanks with the correct word or phrase.

1 The bank needs to verify my _____ before opening the account.

2 A utility bill can be used as _____.

3 My passport is valid, but my driving licence has _____.

4 I need to provide additional _____ because I am not resident in Ireland.

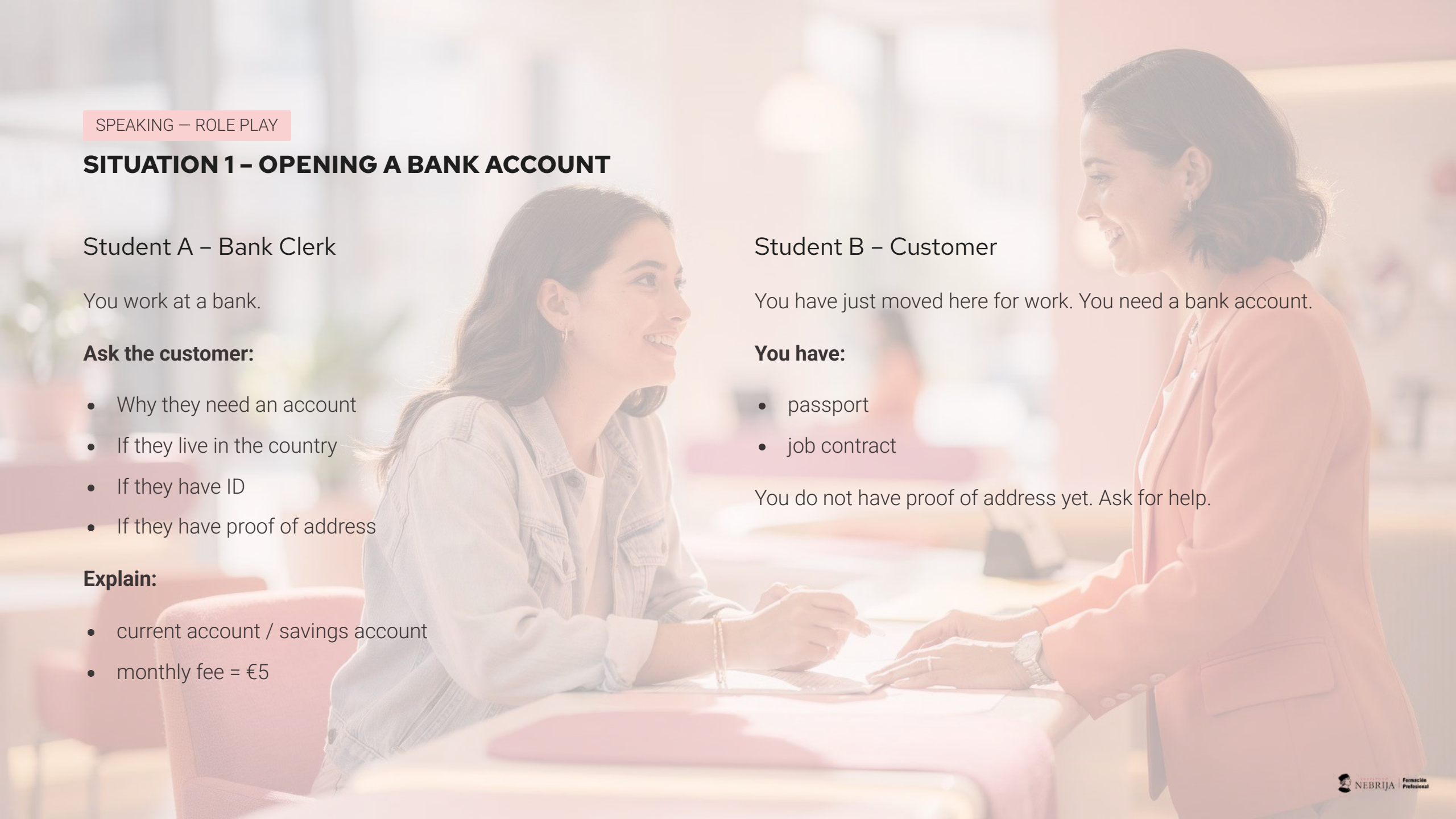
5 The bank needs _____ identification with a photograph.

6 I am currently _____ in Spain, but I have moved to Ireland for work.

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SPEAKING — ROLE PLAY

SITUATION 1 – OPENING A BANK ACCOUNT



Student A – Bank Clerk

You work at a bank.

Ask the customer:

- Why they need an account
- If they live in the country
- If they have ID
- If they have proof of address

Explain:

- current account / savings account
- monthly fee = €5

Student B – Customer

You have just moved here for work. You need a bank account.

You have:

- passport
- job contract

You do not have proof of address yet. Ask for help.

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SPEAKING — ROLE PLAY

SITUATION 2 – APPLYING FOR A TAX NUMBER



Student A – Government Officer

Ask the applicant:

- Full name
- Address
- Why they need the number
- Current job situation

Explain:

- processing time = 2 weeks

Student B – Applicant

You need a tax number because you start a new job next month.
You are staying with a friend temporarily.

Ask:

- what documents you need
- if temporary address is acceptable

SPEAKING — ROLE PLAY

SITUATION 3 – PASSPORT CONTROL

Student A – Border Officer

Ask:

- Purpose of visit
- Length of stay
- Accommodation
- Return ticket

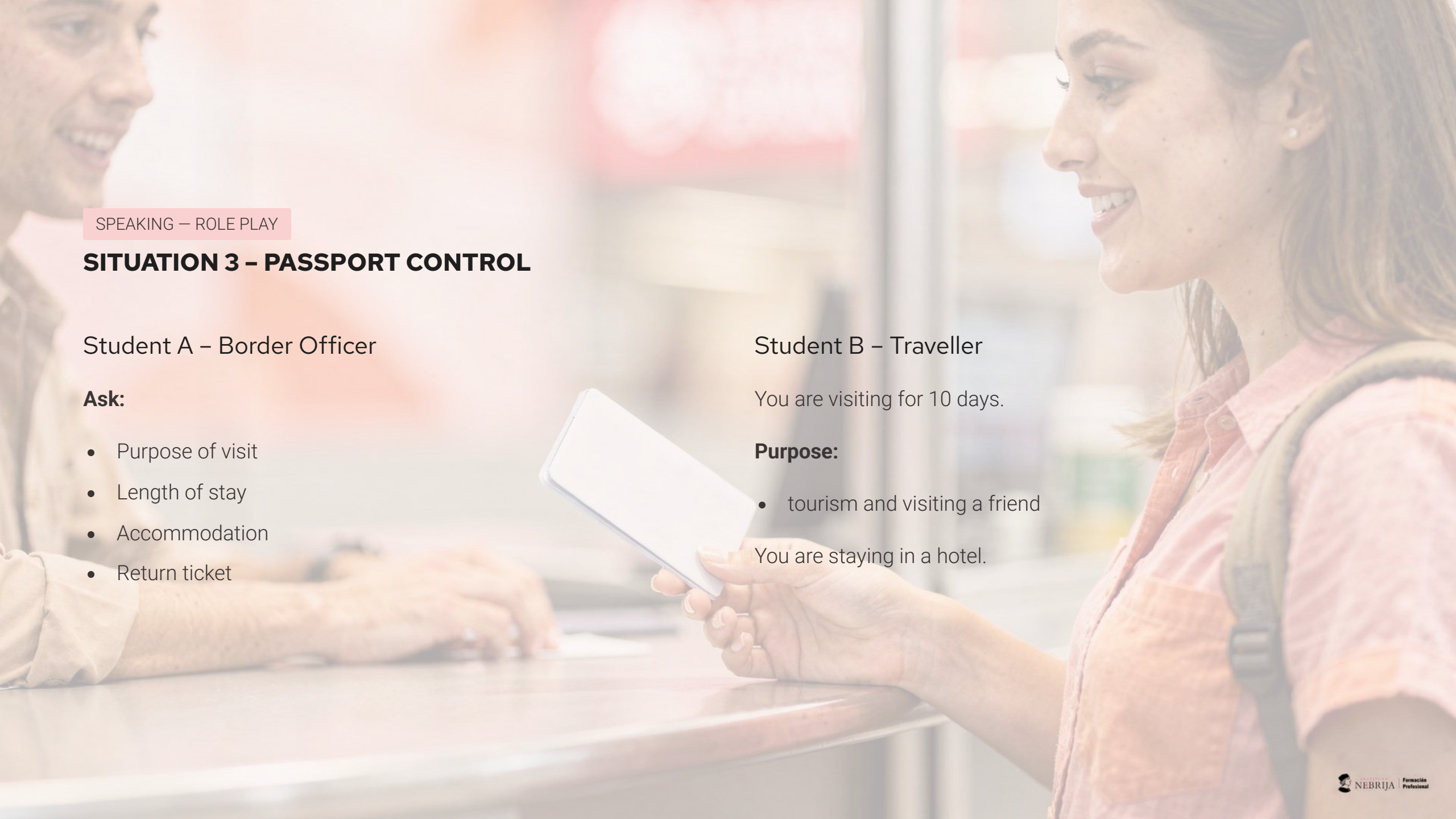
Student B – Traveller

You are visiting for 10 days.

Purpose:

- tourism and visiting a friend

You are staying in a hotel.



SPEAKING — ROLE PLAY

SITUATION 4 – HEALTH INSURANCE

Student A – Insurance Advisor

Explain plans:

- Basic plan = €25/month
- Full plan = €45/month

Ask about:

- age
- work situation
- medical needs

Student B – New Worker

You moved abroad for work. You want cheap insurance but good emergency cover.

Ask questions.





SPEAKING — GROUP ACTIVITY

Bureaucracy Challenge Circuit

Practice speaking fluently in real-life situations using formal English.

📋 How it works

- Work in groups of 4
- Each group rotates through the previous situations
- 4 minutes speaking

🏢 The four offices

- Bank Office
- Tax Number Office
- Passport Control
- Insurance Office

Each round: one student = employee/officer, one = customer/applicant. Then swap roles.

SPEAKING — USEFUL EXPRESSIONS

Useful Expressions

Asking for Information

- I'd like to know…
- Could you tell me…?
- What documents do I need?
- How long does it take?
- Is there a fee?

Clarifying

- Could you repeat that, please?
- Sorry, I didn't understand.
- What do you mean by…?

Explaining Problems

- I've just moved here.
- I don't have proof of address yet.
- There seems to be a mistake.
- My card is not working.

Offering Help

- Let me check that for you.
- You will need…
- I recommend this option.
- The best solution is…

Ending Politely

- Thank you for your help.
- I appreciate your assistance.
- Have a nice day.

GAME

TIME TO PLAY A 🎮!

VOCABULARY REVIEW

Let's review everything we've learned!



Thanks!



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